Diaries and Forgotten Homes

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Diaries and Forgotten Homes

by Nexus Nexus

for my mother, with love

Year 21, Day 1

Mom just gave me this book for my New Year's gift. She told me to write all of my feelings into it but I don't really know what my feelings are right now. So much has happened in the last year and putting it into words isn't going to happen. I would draw instead but there are all of these lines across the page so I guess I would rather write. It's really hot up here in my room, but I was outside and it's even worse out there. My butt is stuck to my chair haha...

This is dumb.

Year 21, Day 2

I told mom that I didn't know what to write and that the diary isn't working. She just told me to keep going at it even if I can't find the words to say because it's supposed to help me anyways. I did get a big stack of paper to draw on so at least there's something nice about the start of this year. If I have to write my feelings I would say I feel hot, sweaty, and my head hurts. I know that this isn't really what she means but I literally could not tell you how hard it is to find something else to talk about. It's not like I want to write about Aislin or that motherfucker who left us to freeze all alone. Mom says I shouldn't hate her for it because it's not her fault but I know it's not true. I've seen her eyes before and they're bad, evil eyes. Mom just doesn't know her like I did. I can't do this.

Year 21, Day ~~173~~ 174

Mom found this stupid book. I don't know how but someone spotted it in the hiding place in the garden and told her about it so now I'm in trouble for speaking trash about her. It just isn't fair to me, I don't get it. I was doing just fine recently but then she

gave me this book back and I'm thinking about all of that again. None of this is my fault but now I'm grounded for writing motherfucker in a book that no one else was supposed to even read. I've heard both of them use words that are way worse but *they're adults so they're above all rules and blah blah blah*. I know it's all nonsense but I really can't do much. I turn 14 in a month, so hopefully I'll get a better gift then. My mom is a mythical hero, you would think I get some sort of perks from that, but I'm just locked up in this room that's getting colder by the day.

Year 21, Day 176

My hands are super numb right now. I guess autumn is here, but even then they usually don't freeze up like this. Maybe I'm just stressed or maybe the heating isn't working properly. I remember auntie Entrapta once came in and fixed those in our castle during the winter. She was funny, I liked her a lot. That was years ago, though. I was soooooo young oh man, I must have been like 4 or 5. I miss those days when I would just sit by the big fire with Aislin or moms or really anyone. Ever since that one winter everyone has gotten really distant and I don't have any more friends. There haven't been any new tutors since Gardener, and for the first time I kind of miss school. It sure beats doing nothing all day or walking around the forests outside. Maybe I'll try poetry? I think Aislin used to do it a lot so I'll see if she rubbed off on me.

~~*My hands are really cold,*~~

~~*I think I'm getting old,*~~

~~*In my hand this pen I hold,*~~

~~*This paper I will fold,*~~

I don't really know how poetry works, I'll be honest.

Year 21, Day 180

My hands are turning blue, so I really shouldn't write, but I got the weird urge to do that right now. Maybe it's the extreme boredom or maybe I'm sick or maybe I don't know. My head is hurting a lot right now and it's kind of hard to see straight. Maybe I should go see the doctor. Yeah I'm not gonna waste my time writing right now.

Year 22, Day 1

One year. It's been one year and all I managed to write were 5 little entries. I've gotta take up more pages in this or mom will be sad or something. Time away from, well, everything really helped me on my poetry. I just read that first one I wrote and had a good laugh. I'll do one right now.

Shivering hands write,

Not knowing what they will say,

Maybe it won't matter,

It's not the best, like, I would not be comfortable reading this in front of people, but it's better than whatever I was trying to do last year. I'm a lot more mature now I think. My mom thinks otherwise but I just don't act mature around her because I don't want to. Why should I? D.T. came over a while ago and they thought I was just fine. D.T. is the *BEST!* They got me this really cool dagger that I had to hide from mom because we all know how that would go down. Who am I even writing this to? I'd rather burn this diary than let anyone else see it, so I don't know why I'm addressing it like someone will. Eh, whatever I don't really care. I'm just going to bed it's too late and too hot to write.

Year 22, Day 2

~~*Home is quite a funny word,*~~

~~*Either building or a bird,*~~

~~*Love is quite a fleeting sound,*~~

~~*Loathing might just be too loud,*~~

~~*O...*~~

Figs and dates and lemons dance,

In the summertime,

Nectarines reach out their hands,

Never touching mine,

Roving watermelons threaten

Oranges and limes,

Canopies of mango weapons

Kill one sullen, stationary

Sweetberry

I'm trying a thing where each letter in the beginning spells out a word. It's really hard to come up with a poem on 9 lines though. That last one felt a bit weird to read. Maybe I just have to work on it more. I get kind of bored after sitting for 30 minutes just thinking about a rhyme for "time" and stuff. Wait, rhyme rhymes with time. That would be a funny poem. I'll think of something tomorrow I'm too hungry.

Free up time left and right,

Until rhymes are neat to write,

Cover up the secret that I

Know they'll never hope to find,

It's not like anyone is gonna read that but if they do, they won't even know! It's genius hahahaha! Okay I'm sleepy, good night diary.

Year 22, Day 6

I've been writing a lot, but not in this diary. I sort of forgot it existed because all day for the past few days I've been scribbling out on larger sheets of paper instead of these tiny lines. But today is her birthday. I know what I used to feel like and I still sort of feel like that but it's really complicated. I don't know if I hate her or love her but more than all of that I just miss her. I miss everything she used to let me get away with, or all of the times I almost beat her at chess, or when she found the first knife that D.T. gave me and didn't take it away. Mom did though. I just wanted to write a little poem for her here.

for my mother, with love, I hope you're okay,

I miss your fuzzy arms and your hair like a bouquet,

not the sky, far above, that we both see the same,

damn the ocean below that breaks me with waves,

my mind is not set on the grandness of life,

every thought that I think is of you, my mother's wife

I closed the diary and set it down. Fires raged in my eyes as they sizzled and boiled in protest of reading such a personal story. I could not bear to read on longer, but I knew that I eventually would. Finn had been such a large figure in my life, and for their words to jump out at me on this page meant something serious. It meant that these were all the words I would get.

the year of poems

Year 22, Day 7

Some more poems. Mom thinks I'm finally good at something else so I should practice.

~~*I don't know how to start a verse*~~

~~*My words all end up in a hearse*~~

No that's dumb. I'll think for a bit.

Torches keep the bugs away

Torches light the halls

Torches circle air and space

Torches fight the Fall

Torches kill the winter night

Torches warm and thaw

But torches in the summertime

Make no sense at all

It's really hot in this room still. I've been stuck here for a while because my legs are still too weak from my sickness to move around a lot, so I've been told to just stay here.

~~*My legs are weak, they crack and bleed,*~~

~~*But nothing lasts forever,*~~

~~*My hands are*~~

~~*My hands still*~~

My hands were made in concrete strong as steel,

They bend but never crack against the weight,

My arms that hold them up don't even feel,

The heaviness that both of them create,

I'm trying to write a sonnet. I read a bunch of them, and they're really weird, but mom enjoys them. She says they're "old style" or something. I do remember, actually, Aislin told me about these a while ago, but I don't remember what she said. I'm trying to do one now but it's a really tricky style. I'm really hot in my room but hopefully the autumn will come early.

Year 22, Day 8

I'm going to write a poem a day. I'm drawing too, just not in this teeny tiny little book. I don't really know what to write about so I guess I'll just start by describing the look outside the window every day.

Water glistens white where the sun strikes blindly,

The plants underneath grow strong,

Fish are swimming rapidly but not quite sightly,

Because they're far too far away to know,

I can't see far out the clear glass beside me,

But images reach me the same,

The clouds have departed and the pier sits slyly,

Flowing through the river like a dream,

Year 22, Day 9

Phlegm rising higher by the minute,

Eyes spilling over down my cheeks,

Nightmares of things I've not admitted,

Haunt my sleeping body like a creek,

Visions of her falling through the fabric,

Make their way around the walls of stone,

They slither through the cracks into the attic,

And sit there leaving not enough alone,

I flipped through the seemingly endless pages, all of them scrawled over with poems. Finn had always said they liked poetry, but to this extent I was not aware. The candle flickered and danced around its wick, rocking to and fro with the movement of the boat along the waves. I thought about the giant beast that lay miles underneath me, wondering if it knew how lucky it was to be alive. It had my little moon to thank. I didn't cry as I read through each day, but I wanted to. My terrified, terrifying eyes were nothing but deserts now, red marks that extended down my cheeks where I continuously wiped the leaking flow of freshwater. Every sound in the boat reverberated through the hollow tunnel between my ears, stopping as they went by but never staying for long. I was entirely engrossed in the writings of a little genius.

Year 22, Day 204

By this time I woke

Eyes still cold and tightly closed

Fifteen years ago

It's my birthday!!!!! I'm not sick like I was last year, so I'm already happy about today. It's really early, so the party hasn't started yet, not even the sun has woken up. That's a funny thought actually, because Gardener told me how the sun is always burning bright and Etheria circles around it. But if that's the case, when does the sun burn out? If it's always been giving us light and heat and stuff, how is it still alive after thousands of years? I should have asked him while I had the chance, he probably knew. That was like, three years ago? I don't really know to be honest, time in this castle just passes me by. But it's about to be my birthday so I hope this time never escapes me! Alright, I'm going to go back to bed so mom doesn't know I was up too late.

TODAY WAS THE BEST! D.T. came by and they're always so fun to be around. I think they're the only person in the entire kingdom that understands me fully, more than even Mom could. Their love for traveling and generally just being a badass is my entire dream. The food today was great, the party was fun, I got to play some amazing games that Entrapta whipped up with some mechanical parts and whatever all around the castle. This is SO much better than last year. I'm really tired though so I'm just going to head to bed. I don't want to kill myself out of exhaustion today.

The last sentence stung in my eyes. I felt as if the universe itself was laughing down on me, the most powerful yet most unfortunate woman in the world.

This Puny World pt. 3

Evening halted the movement of air with an outstretched hand. I was not yet ready to read the rest of the diary, so I bode my time by eating constantly and sleeping for the rest of the day. Anything I could do to keep my mind off that book was welcome to my daily schedule. While he had been rather annoying, it pained me to have had to see Swift Wind go. He made trips across the world much easier for me, and with Glimmer not teleporting me anywhere I wanted, the boat would have to do. I was always overly sentimental, or at least that's what I've been told by everyone in my life, Catra, The Princesses, Shadow Weaver... It was a trait that caused me great struggle, but it reminded me of who I was and grounded my mind in a sense of self. Apparently my emotions were not such a bad thing, as I had outlasted everyone else in my family, which may not be a good thing. It's funny how the most powerful being in the universe still can't bring people back after they die, and if I could I'm not sure if they would appreciate it. For most of them, I'm sure they had made peace with death in there final moments, the short time before they kissed it on the lips.

Year 22, Day 241

Falling, Fleeting, Famous Feelings,

Fucking, Folding, Failure, Foaming

Mouths Munch Many Men,

Minutes March, Marrying

Necrophiliacs, Never

Necks or Needed Naps,

Laying Long Like a Log,

Lovers Leave, Loud enough.

I'm not really sure what this poem means, I'm just writing what I think sounds good. I've heard that if you let your consciousness spill out on the page, you can tell what you're thinking, but this just looks like nonsense. Maybe it's the universe trying to tell me something super cryptic. Why is it that whenever there's some big stupid prophecy, the oracles or gods can never just say something that makes sense. If you want me to do something, literally just tell me, *Oh Almighty Moon and Heavens Above* blah blah blah. All that talk is bullshit if you ask me. I really hope mom doesn't read this but I think the First Ones were just playing a practical joke on archaeologists because they seem kind of stupid and pretentious from what I've learned from my new Tutor. I like her though, he's Bow's sister. It's strange, because I remember him telling me he had twelve brothers, but those things change I suppose. I want to get a cat. I know it's weird because Melog died when I was young and Catra left us, but I've always felt a little bit lonely without a little companion. I guess a few years ago, I always had someone, but now I don't even have any imaginary friends, let alone real ones. Mom won't let me far from the castle grounds without a guard, says there's "danger" out there. All I know is that the Horde was dangerous, and they died out before I was even born. I'm fast and I know self-defense, I'm sure I would be fine. Well, whatever, I'm gonna go draw now. I like writing here but I'm not a novelist, it's still not that fun.

Year 22, Day 242

I still draw her face

I don't know what it looks like

I fall flat on mine

I keep drawing Aislin. Maybe it's because her birthday is next week and my brain sort of remembers that, I've heard the whole "anniversary effect" thing. I just still miss her, even after all of this

time. Maybe it's because there hasn't been anyone new, any replacement. There really isn't a replacement for Aislin. I miss D.T. I really just miss everyone, Aislin, Double Trouble, Gardener, even Catra. I miss them so much. I've not been feeling very well recently, but not like I'm sick. I don't know how to describe it but it's like there's just something flapping away in the middle of my stomach. I'm scared.

I read the diary in short bursts. Often it's when I'm feeling sad, but it makes no sense since reading it only makes me sadder. It's as if I'm addicted to it like some sort of drug, but that drug was my child, my Moon. The boat rocked steadily, our destination seeming an infinite distance out away from us. Perhaps it was, but the captain seemed to know what she was doing. It's odd, I knew at the time that I recognized her from somewhere, but I didn't remember her. Maybe she was playing some sort of mind game or illusion, but it seemed unlikely that someone so impactful could just slip my mind like that.

I often found myself looking down at the serpent that lay still, out of the reach of my vision. I knew it was there, and I wanted to know what I was thinking. I wanted it to know everything, but it was an ignorant creature, unaware of the turmoil directly above its head, or the war that was breaking out because of something it didn't even do. It could not defend itself, however if it woke it may be host to a power we could not even imagine. I sank back down belowdecks, the temperature dropping below a comfortable feeling, and laid down on the uncomfortable cot. Even when I wasn't looking at the ocean, I saw the serpent coiling around my eyes. I could see its head and its tail, things I had never observed for myself other than in drawings or the descriptions that They had sent me before the events swept us all away. I was a woman untethered by the restraints of living in a world filled with equals, because I knew that my pain would soon be far greater. I didn't have to think about the present anymore, I had gained that privilege for myself.

Being the strongest *thing* alive comes with many upsides. Ever since the Great War ended and I settled down with Catra, I had never felt threatened. I'd felt afraid, lonely, unimportant, unloved, uncontrollable, but never threatened. If there was ever a bully, a blocked path, a stray hair, I would be able to take care of it. Never had I known what death was like. I'd seen it take the hands of those around me, my friends and family, random people fighting for or against me, animals and plants that did not care which way or the other, even things that were never alive to begin with. I learned that I was bound to live a while longer, maybe forever if I was unlucky, so I settled in for the haul and set my mind straight. I knew I would outlive Glimmer, Bow, Catra, and Finn, and I knew it would hurt for a while, but a while would not be long for a being such as myself. While reading that diary, I realized exactly the opposite, pain never leaves you. It had been nearly a decade since they had died and I still never grew out of the pain of losing them, nor that of losing Catra. Bow, still alive and well, was my only friend left that was there for me at all times. I would still visit Perfuma and Scorpia, sometimes Mermista and Sea Hawk, but their age was starting to show. I was growing more the same while they were growing apart from me. The only thing that was as immortal as I was just so happened to be the book I was holding in my hands. The last living member of my family.

Year 22, Day 243

The mint leaf lies still in the soil,

It's grown ever larger than before,

Its stem rises high from the dirt and the water,

Feeding its roots below the soft, dark hole,

Larger than a tiny seedling it has become,

Breaking out of hardened shells and more,

Absorbing tiny particles from air out of our lungs,

And in a half a second we just pluck it from the ground,

I'm not sure I like this one very much, it's a little forced. I was thinking about how it was funny that all of these plants we eat are all alive, or at least that's what the tutor told me, and they grow and grow super big and tall and then suddenly we just kill them and eat them. It works the same for meat, but plants are just a little bit weird because I'm not sure if they can even feel it. What an awful life it would be, being a plant, you'd just sit around doing nothing all day everyday. You wouldn't be able to have friends, parents, fun, family, adventure, nothing. You would be stuck where you are, your roots in the ground, probably put there by some farmer, and then when the time is right your head gets chopped off and eaten. I feel pretty bad for plants, but I also don't think they know anything. They don't have brains, so how could they?

Year 22, Day 244

I cannot think,

I cannot feel, I cannot taste,

I cannot smell, I cannot see, I cannot hear,

I cannot love, I cannot live, I cannot breathe, I cannot conceive,

I cannot die, I cannot cry, I cannot fly, I cannot sigh, I can never lie,

I am true, I am simple, I am unkind, I am fair,

I am humble, I am sincere, I am here,

I am there, I am where?

I am a plant.

I've really always liked plants, they're my favorite things to draw, but it's funny how little I actually knew about plants, like REALLY knew about them. I asked my tutor today if plants could think and he went "oh of course not, Finn, they don't have brains" and I told him, well of course but neither do some of us. He laughed at that, which made me sort of happy, but I started wondering about *being*. Why do brains let us think thoughts and not plants? He told me "well the electrical signals between our brain cells make up memories and thoughts and feelings" and I thought that was quite odd, but if aunt Entrapta can make a robot feel, why can't someone make a plant do the same? What about those plants that snap up flies and eat them? He told me "well they just react to the environment around them and change based on that" and I asked him isn't that just what thinking is? He laughed a little when I said that, which made me sort of confused because I hadn't said anything funny. He just ended the conversation with "it's a little too complicated to explain to you now, someday you'll get it" and insisted we get back to working on geometry. Like I'd ever have to know how to calculate angles in a triangle. Math is a little dumb, and I'm sorry if Entrapta ever finds this, but unless you're gonna be a mathematician, there's no need to know it. Why the fuck is it getting taught to me? Why don't plants learn math, they certainly can think, or at least that's what my tutor seemed to insinuate by backing off from the conversation. The world is so stupid sometimes.

They were always so imaginative. I admired Finn's sharp wits, even if they were aimed at my face, since they brought a little entertainment with them everywhere they went. I asked them how they got to be so funny once, but they couldn't really tell me. It was just their way of talking, I supposed. I felt awful keeping them in the palace at all times, but Glimmer and I agreed that it would be better to wait out the war for a little longer. We had no idea the threat that we had faced at the time, or the threat that we posed to them too. War, especially this one, is a stupid concept. It's people fighting for their lives while trying to take someone else's. If Finn where here, they would probably ask "well

if no one fights, then no one has to fight for their lives, right?" And they would be correct, but it doesn't always work like that. This puny world is full of these great contradictions, and war is right in the middle of it. All I could do was continue my mission and hope that the world didn't end while I was away.

As I was thinking about all of this, the boat finally skidded to a stop, hitting the shore with a sickening creak. The hull scratched loudly against the marble and rubble below, but it held its shape just fine. I took a deep breath and put the book back into my coat pocket, its home for the past few eons. I had no idea how long I had been on that boat, or if I would have to go in some more, but I was ready for anything. The captain called for me, and I stood up from my sedentary spot on the bed. My feet made soft explosions as they rocked the gentle wooden floor beneath them, the air making waves up my legs as it displaced itself from underneath my soles. Everything was there for my mind, and nothing escaped: The slight rocking that the ship still kept, the shallow breath of the strange captain that I didn't remember, the sound of my hair moving back and forth with every step I took, the ruffle of the sails high above, the small waves bombarding the sides of our vessel, the very movements of the eyes and stars in the sky, where my Moon and my wife lay now, abandoned by Mother Time. As I emerged from belowdecks, I slipped the hood off of my head, the air far too warm to keep it on, and my ears perked up as the cloth slid past them. I adjusted my eyes, the light a little too much for them after being in the dark for a while, and squinted outwards. In front of me and the captain was the largest building I had ever seen in my life. At the center of the Great Ocean, the largest mass of water on our tiny little planet, sat the base of a throne of a God. The nest of demons, the birthplace of angels, the graveyard of deities. I stepped off of the boat and onto the solid white ground of the center of the universe. I was finally ready.

Former Friends and Foes

It had been years since I had stopped talking to Mermista. In a letter I received from Finn, I learned about many of the horrors of the true nature of their war with the so-called "pirates" and exactly where their motivations had lain. I told Bow about their scheme, but he said that the Bright Moon army was much too small to make a difference against the Royal Navy, and because they were allied with the New Republic of the Fright Zone, we would be obliterated in seconds if we tried to step to them. It was true. Ever since the war waged against the old Horde many decades ago, the forces at our disposal were weak, small, and unwilling to go through another traumatic event. Our kingdom relied solely on trading and good relations to keep itself afloat, knowing that if no one wanted to invade us, no one would. I knew most of the leaders of the other kingdoms and was good friends with many, although a few had slipped out of touch.

Queen Frosta, to our north, was the youngest and most rash of any of the leaders. She kept up with us until Glimmer died, which caused her to go silent for many months. Eventually, she opened up her ears again and the Kingdom of Snows opened up its arms to the world, in desperate need of food and supplies for a deadlier winter than normal. They helped us through ours and we helped them through theirs. Frosta was the only one of our friends who had not yet settled down with someone, and regularly cycled through lovers and flings, not too interested in marrying at all. She wasn't even young enough for that to have made sense, but we loved her anyways because that's just who she was.

Year 22, Day 300

Purple is the sky

Purple, my favorite color

My toes are purple

It's COLD. We're staying overnight in Auntie Frosta's castle because tomorrow is the princess prom thing that I've been told so much about. Mom told me I came here when I was a little kid, but that was so long ago I can really not remember any of it. It's been a while since I've seen Frosta, but I think she's pretty weird. She always likes to disagree with mom, and I honestly can't tell if she's joking half the time. It gets super annoying after a while, because I think she thinks I'm an idiot. I know she was the leader of her entire kingdom when she was a little kid or something, but that doesn't mean I'm weak because I still have a parent. Okay, that sounds weird when I read it out, I know her parents died in the war, and that's probably why she's like this. Anyways, it's time to sleep, and this bed is actually really comfy, so I can't wait to dream only the best dreams.

Year 22, Day 301

Sing and dance and boredom,

Of course I locked the doors,

On thick skulls and thick floors,

This big hall is old,

I am young,

The princess prom was so BORING!!! I literally have never felt less excited in my life. Frosta was sitting at her throne and looked totally mean and unlike herself. I thought she hated being queen, but I guess this is the one time she seems to enjoy it. Some jackass got kicked out for bringing an electric hand warmer, Entrapta's invention, and I swear I could have seen her smile as she kicked him out of the hall. I'm in the guest quarters right now and I think the party is still happening, cuz I can hear people below me and music is still playing. Mom came around earlier and tried to open the door, but I locked it up and kept quiet. She went away eventually, but I think she 100% knows I'm in here. She'll

come break them down eventually, I think she's just going to Frosta to ask permission. Apparently she had been kicked out of the ball a while back, a few years into the war, and I only heard about that from Auntie Double Trouble, who was here today for a bit and then left. I think they were the one with the hand warmers, if I'm being honest. I hear Mom coming up the stairs now so I'll end today's entry here.

Keeping to tradition, the Kingdom of Snows was neutral in the war overseas. Most of it was fought too far south for them to even notice, had it not been for the thousands of refugees from Salineas banging at their doors and ours. Even the New Fright Zone was in danger, a few attacks having been led from their many rivers. Frosta seemed like she was constantly hesitant. I know that she never really had any training to become queen of a nation, let alone the largest nation in the world, but she did have a good heart. Many years of her youth were spent with Scorpia and Perfuma, queens of the Crimson Waste. Although they were technically royalty, and should have known how to rule, their lands were not strictly theirs. There were no cities, ports, laws, or really anything else in the Crimson Waste. There were hardly any *people*, let alone a governing body. Most of the time the queens spent was spent on relaxing, sunbathing, and generally being lovely people. I don't know that for sure, but last time I went to visit that's all they did. I only took Finn there to see them once, but I know they loved it. Maybe it's because that's where Double Trouble spent most of their time. I wanted to keep them apart, but looking back on it, I should not have forced that relationship to crumble. They relied on each other more than I knew, and reading the daily entries of this diary showed me that. I had never felt more regret, but there was nothing to do with it now but push on and finish the mission that Finn started.

Year 24, Day 63

We're on a boat to the New Fright Zone today, it's quite bumpy bit it's fast. I don't really like boats all that much, they sort of make

me sick and wet and I hate being sick and wet. I can tolerate this boat though, cuz in a few days we're going to be on the transport to the Crimson Waste. And that transport can *not* be a boat, or so I've been told, since the Crimson Waste is a big desert. Mom looks a bit nervous, which is sort of how she always looks, but I think it's because we're going to be close to D.T. She hates them for some reason, and I think it might be my fault. It's getting pretty hot, the ink on this page is beginning to run a bit. Even the summer in Bright Moon isn't this bad, we're usually just sitting pretty with our weather. I can't understand how Auntie Perfuma can handle it here, she's supposed to be the queen of the Whispering Woods, but somehow she made it all the way to the desert. Scorpia must really be something... Anyways, I'm going to go sip on a cool drink while I wait to get there cuz I am sweating up a storm.

Year 24, Day 64

We've made it to the New Fright Zone, stuff's happening super fast so I can't write a lot today.

Year 24, Day 66

We've just gotten into our rooms at the Crimson Waste. I'm super tired right now, but I skipped yesterday's entry so I feel like I have to do one today. We spent all day traveling yesterday and most of today too. I haven't seen Scorpia or Perfuma yet, but some of their "henchmen" (Mom's words not mine) escorted us all the way to where we are now. I'm not entirely sure where that is, but I do know that it is dry. My mouth feels like it's full of sand, and it might be, but I have been drinking water constantly and I still feel like a dried up leaf. I'll sleep for now, at least the bed is comfortable. It's a sort of hammock thing but there's a bunch of pillows so I think I'll sleep well tonight. Anything beats sleeping on a giant tank or a boat.

I remember that visit quite well. It was one of the only times where everything went smoothly, whereas usually Finn would find some way to hijack whatever plans we had. The solution to that was just to not make any. I knew we were going to go to the Waste, but once we were there, I left it all up to Perfuma and Scorpia. I trusted those two dearly, even if their son Dionaea didn't really like Finn at all. I don't know exactly what they did to upset him, but I was sure they did something stupid like kids often do. Scorpia and Perfuma were not ones to mettle with the affairs of others, especially during the war, so after the fighting really got intense they sort of faded away. I think all they wanted was a peaceful life for their son, and I can respect that. I tried to give Finn that chance, but the universe was not on my side. They lost so much, Catra, Aislin, Glimmer, even the Gardener that used to tutor him killed himself. I couldn't tell them that, but it was still a big disappointment. Finn lived a difficult life, but I find a little sliver of joy knowing that they lived it rooted in what they knew was right. They died saving this serpent, and so will I if it comes to that. No matter what Mermista thinks of me.

Year 31, Day 241

I think Mermista is onto us. The General, his son, and I were all invited to a royal feast today, which I thought was going to be really boring. I was right, but now I'm actually more nervous than I am bored. We've been going on undercover missions under the Royal Navy for a year together now, the anniversary being today, but I think there are other reasons she's inviting us here today. We're all alone in separate rooms, really big rooms, but there are guards outside in the hall. I normally don't see guards standing in hallways at night, and I'm the moon of *She-Ra*. I would know. During the dinner, she kept asking us about our findings and if we had discovered something big. We have, of course, but we always reported back little tidbits and half-truths after each mission, so I don't know why she would ask us that other than if she knew we were spying both ways. I don't know why I'm even writing this down, because if the guards find this journal they are going to have our heads for treason. I've written some really shady shit in

this, and we could literally be executed for it. I never really liked Auntie Mermista, but she is on another level of crazy right now. Not even Sea Hawk is sticking his neck out for us. I think he's scared too. I'm going to go to bed, but I am keeping this book in the pillowcase and I have my knife in hand. I am not going to sleep well tonight.

Mermista did eventually find out, of course, and I haven't spoken to her since then. It's been nearly two years now, but it feels like eons. It seems almost humorous to note that she didn't even get the satisfaction of executing Finn, as the nation Salineas was fighting against, the Protectors of the Serpent, got to them first. Serpienta's letter to me was almost sickening, it was put at the end of the diary, but I've never been more proud of my little baby. They made a difference, and that's all a mother can hope their child to do.

Year 33, Day 204

This is not Finn writing, this is Serpienta. I know that Finn only had one remaining family member left, and so I plan on giving this journal to you, Adora. She-Ra. I have never met you, and I might die before I get to do that, but I sincerely hope that this book comes into your hands by any ways possible. I loved Finn, inside and out, and I think they may have loved me too, but I know they loved you more than the sun and moons themselves. They would talk fondly of you, almost sounding sorry for leaving, and I could tell how much they thought about you every day. In the end, Finn was killed by the Protectors of the Serpent, the very side we were trying to protect. It was an accident, but one that cost the lives of at least two of them, and one of us. We were in a Royal Salineas boat, so they fired like they normally would, and Finn fell down from the top deck to the bottom, splitting their head open. I sat with them as they died, holding their hand, and they looked more happy and peaceful than I ever saw in life. I think they knew that they would be okay, and that they made a difference. Oh, did Finn make a difference. In this last mission,

Finn defended the Serpent itself from a deathly attack from Salineas. They went down under the water with a sort of leaf, I'm not sure where they even found it, and suddenly they were glowing and all of the Salineas submarines sunk to the bottom of the sea. It was painful, fighting for both sides and neither side, but they did what had to be done. I'm not sure exactly what it is, but I know that that Serpent is the guiding force of life on our planet and that killing it would kill everyone. Finn told me that it was supposed to guard some sort of heart, but that they were wounded and put into a slumber by an army many thousands of years ago. It's some crazy stuff, stuff that I'm not even done processing, but Finn knew it like instinct. You should be very proud to have raised such a precious person. Let us remember Finn in love, and nothing else. Returning to shore may result in my death, so before that happens I will be sure to send this to Bright Moon with a messenger. I am so sorry Adora, mother of Finn, protector of our world.

Year 22, Day 205

I'm writing on the last page of this journal because I want to see if I ever finish all the pages. When that happens, I want to see this and remember what I was like years ago. Like a time capsule. So, Finn, have you gotten married yet? Has Mom let you move out of the palace or are you still trapped in your room? What year is it? This book is super thick, and I counted enough pages to last for a decade, so did you make it that far? Did you have to get a new book? I guess if you're reading this again you would have had to need a new book. I just turned fifteen yesterday and I feel more like an adult than ever. What's being an adult feel like? Do you miss being a kid? I guess I can't know the answers to these questions yet, but I will. In time.

Goodbye Finn, good luck finding a new book!

The last page was stained with teardrops, only some of them mine.

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